

Rajesh Dammala

Observability & DevOps Tools Engineering Manager — Reliability & Developer Productivity

rajesh.dammala@gmail.com • 425-229-0060 • [linkedin.com/in/rajesh-dammala](https://www.linkedin.com/in/rajesh-dammala)
Raleigh, NC · Hybrid (On-site)

https://rdammala.github.io/LexisNexis_Observability-DevOps-Tools-Engineering-Manager/

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Observability and DevOps-tooling engineering manager with 16+ years across mission-critical platforms. Builds and develops high-performing teams; defines vision and standards for metrics, logs, traces, alerting, and SLI/SLO-based service health; owns governance of CI/CD and developer platforms (Azure DevOps, GitHub Enterprise, Jenkins); and manages infrastructure via Terraform. Drives incident excellence (RCA, post-mortems, on-call readiness), ensures security/compliance/cost discipline, embeds observability across the delivery lifecycle, and converts technical information into business value for stakeholders.

CAREER SNAPSHOT

16+ Years in IT / Cloud / Reliability Engineering
100% SLA Across 20+ Mission-Critical Services
30-35% Incidents Auto-Resolved via AI Automation
25,000+ Stale Incidents Eliminated
85%!'98% Operational Efficiency Lift
15-32 Engineers Led Across Global Teams

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and developed engineering teams of 15-32 across the US and India with a culture of reliability and ownership.
- Architected AI-driven incident automation reaching 30-35% auto-resolution across a 24/7/365 platform.
- Reduced resolution time 32% and lifted operational efficiency from 85% to 98% via observability and incident discipline.
- Eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ alerts; cut alert fatigue ~90% through SLI/SLO-based alerting.
- Sustained 100% SLA across 20+ mission-critical services with early instrumentation and on-call readiness.

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Observability Platforms: Metrics / Logs / Traces, SLI / SLO / Error Budgets, Dashboards & Alerting, OpenTelemetry, Datadog / Splunk / New Relic / Grafana (familiar), Kusto (KQL), Power BI, Azure Monitor / AppInsights

DevOps Tools & CI/CD: Azure DevOps, GitHub Enterprise / Git, Jenkins, Pipeline & Repo Governance, Branching Strategy, Build Agents & Integrations

Platform Engineering & IaC: Terraform, CloudFormation (concepts), Bicep / ARM, Configuration

Standardization, Automation, Tool Evaluation (capability/risk/cost)

Reliability & Incident: Incident Response, RCA & Post-Mortems, On-Call Readiness, Detection · Triage · Rollback · Recovery, MTTR Reduction

Cloud: Microsoft Azure, AWS (concepts), Cloud-Native Architecture, Kubernetes (AKS/EKS)

Leadership & Governance: Engineering Team Leadership (15-32), Hiring & Coaching, Access Controls & Auditability, Security & Compliance, Cost Optimization, Cross-functional Communication

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

Engineering Team Leadership (hire/coach/develop) — **Expert**

Observability (metrics/logs/traces, SLI/SLO) — **Expert**

Alerting & Dashboards (KQL/Power BI; Datadog/Grafana familiar) — **Advanced**

CI/CD & DevOps Tools Governance (Azure DevOps, GitHub, Jenkins) — **Expert**

Infrastructure as Code (Terraform) — **Advanced**

Incident Response & RCA — **Expert**

Cloud-Native Architecture (Azure; AWS) — **Advanced**

Security, Compliance & Cost Governance — **Advanced**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Observability & DevOps Tools Engineering Manager — Xbox Services

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra) | Redmond, WA | May 2021 - Present

Leads the team owning enterprise observability platforms and core developer tooling for a 24/7/365 mission-critical platform serving millions.

- Lead and develop the team — hire, coach, set priorities, and build a culture of reliability, ownership, learning, and continuous improvement.
- Set observability direction — defined vision, roadmap, and standards for metrics, logs, traces, alerting, dashboards, and SLI/SLO-based service health using Kusto (KQL), Power BI, Azure Monitor/AppInsights, and OpenTelemetry-aligned instrumentation.
- Own DevOps tools and CI/CD platforms — governance and strategic oversight of Azure DevOps and GitHub Enterprise (Jenkins-class pipelines), with guardrails for repos, branching, pipelines, build agents, and integrations.
- Drive reliability and incident excellence — partner on incident response, RCA, and post-mortems; improved detection, triage, rollback, recovery, and on-call readiness, reducing resolution time 32%.
- Platform engineering and automation — manage platforms via Infrastructure as Code (Terraform); standardize configurations and operational practices; evaluate tools against capability, complexity, risk, and cost.
- Architected AI-driven incident automation reaching 30-35% auto-resolution; eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ redundant alerts.
- Ensured security, compliance, and cost discipline — access controls/reviews, auditable logging, and platform-spend optimization without degrading reliability or developer experience.
- Cross-functional communication — converted technical detail into business value and coordinated stakeholders across application, platform, and infrastructure teams.

Azure Platform & Reliability Engineering Manager — Customer Support Services

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Redmond, WA | Nov 2016 - May 2021

Managed a 15-engineer team across cloud-native platform reliability, observability, and developer enablement.

- Hired, coached, and set priorities for a 15-engineer team; built a culture of reliability, ownership, and continuous improvement.
- Governed CI/CD and developer tooling standards (Azure DevOps, GitHub/Git) including repos, branching, and pipeline guardrails.
- Drove reliability and incident response across cloud-native architectures; partnered with Security on access controls, reviews, and auditability.
- Optimized platform spend and operational practices without degrading reliability or developer experience.

Operations & Observability Lead — Azure Live Site

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Hyderabad, India | May 2012 - Nov 2016

Led 12 senior + 20 engineers operating cloud platforms at 99.95%+ SLA.

- Designed telemetry collection, dashboards, and alerting for 100+ services; promoted early instrumentation and SLI/SLO practices.
- Built PowerShell automation saving thousands of manual hours; standardized operational practices via Infrastructure-as-Code patterns.
- Led incident, problem, and change management; mentored engineers from specialists into technical leads.

Systems Analyst / Data Center Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Hammond, IN | Sep 2009 - Nov 2011

Infrastructure operations and monitoring across enterprise environments.

- Server builds, cluster configuration, and large-scale migrations; deployed monitoring and patches.
- Scripted repetitive operational tasks to improve consistency and reduce manual effort.

SELECTED PROJECTS & CASE STUDIES

Observability Platform & SLI/SLO Standards — Defined org-wide standards for metrics, logs, traces, dashboards, and alerting with SLI/SLO-based service health, improving detection and developer productivity.

CI/CD & DevOps Tools Governance — Governed Azure DevOps/GitHub Enterprise pipelines, repos, branching, and build agents with guardrails balancing capability, complexity, risk, and cost.

AI-Driven Incident Automation — Shipped an AI incident agent (30-35% auto-resolution) integrating telemetry and remediation workflows.

Platform-as-Code Standardization — Managed platforms via Terraform, standardizing configuration and operational practices to raise reliability and developer experience.

Team Build & Reliability Culture — Hired, coached, and developed engineers; established on-call readiness, post-mortem discipline, and continuous-improvement practices.

Security & Cost Governance — Implemented access controls/reviews and auditable logging while optimizing platform spend without degrading reliability.

LEADERSHIP & COLLABORATION

- Led and mentored global teams of 15-32 engineers across the US and India, growing individual contributors into technical leads.
- Central escalation authority and SME for high-severity incidents, coordinating Security, Engineering, Product, and business teams under pressure.
- Ran 1:1s, performance reviews, onboarding, and targeted coaching/enablement plans; built psychologically safe, high-accountability culture.
- Synthesized incident and reliability data into executive reviews driving investment and process decisions.
- Early operationalizer of AI/automation in production support and operations; champion of continuous learning.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified IT Professional — Azure Infrastructure Solutions (70-533, 70-534)
- Microsoft AZ-900 — Azure Fundamentals
- Google Cloud Computing Foundations
- Google — Introduction to Generative AI
- TechMahindra AI White Belt

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Engineering, JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

PROFESSIONAL PHILOSOPHY

Reliability and developer productivity are two sides of the same coin: build a team that owns outcomes, instrument early, alert on what matters (SLI/SLO), govern tooling with guardrails not gates, and turn every incident into durable improvement.